

Running Linux on Windows Using VirtualBox

Many Windows users, especially those thinking of transiting to Linux, would like to first try out the latter on their Windows machines. Here's a way to run Linux on a Windows machine. This article is also a good start for beginners who are new to virtualisation, since it will help them set up their own Linux labs using VirtualBox.

Virtualisation has made it possible to run multiple operating systems on a single computer, simultaneously. In this article, we discuss how to run Linux on a Windows machine. We can achieve this using a hosted hypervisor. Today, there are many hosted hypervisors available in the market, such as VirtualBox, VMware Workstation, and so on. However, we are going to concentrate on VirtualBox, which is free and open source software.

Download and install VirtualBox

VirtualBox is freely available. Visit <https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Downloads> and download it for Windows hosts. At the time of writing this article, the VirtualBox version was 5.2.18.

VirtualBox's installation on Windows is pretty straightforward, just like any other software. After downloading the installer, just double-click on it and follow the on-screen instructions. If everything goes fine, you should see the window of the VirtualBox manager, as shown in Figure 1.

Creating the virtual machine

A virtual machine is an emulation of a computer system. Just like any other physical system, it has memory, a CPU, a



network, storage and other 'peripheral devices'. To create the virtual machine, perform the following steps:

1. Launch *VirtualBox manager*.
2. Go to *Machine->New* menu.
3. Select the name and operating system.
4. Provide memory for the virtual machine.
5. Select the 'Create a virtual hard disk now' option as a brand new virtual machine is being created.
6. Select VDI as the hard disk file type.
7. Select 'Dynamically allocated' as the storage option.
8. Select the file location and size; then click on the *Create* button.

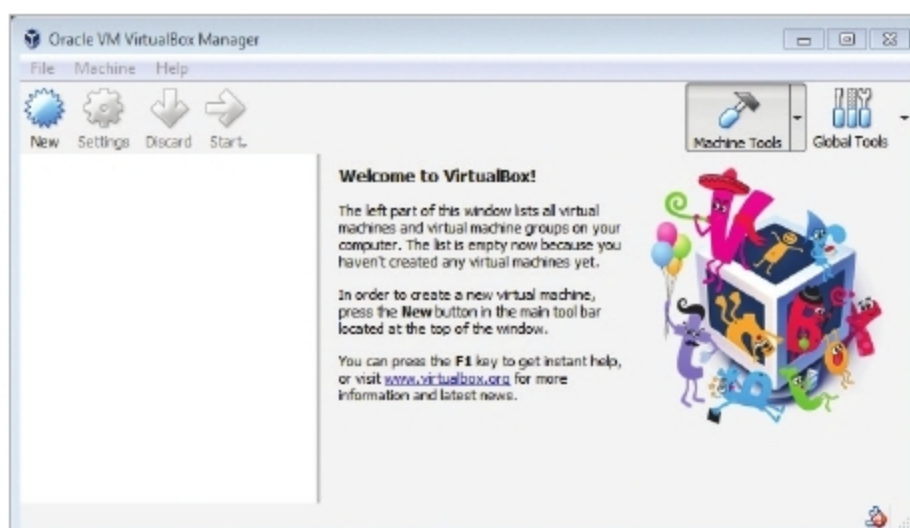


Figure 1: VirtualBox manager

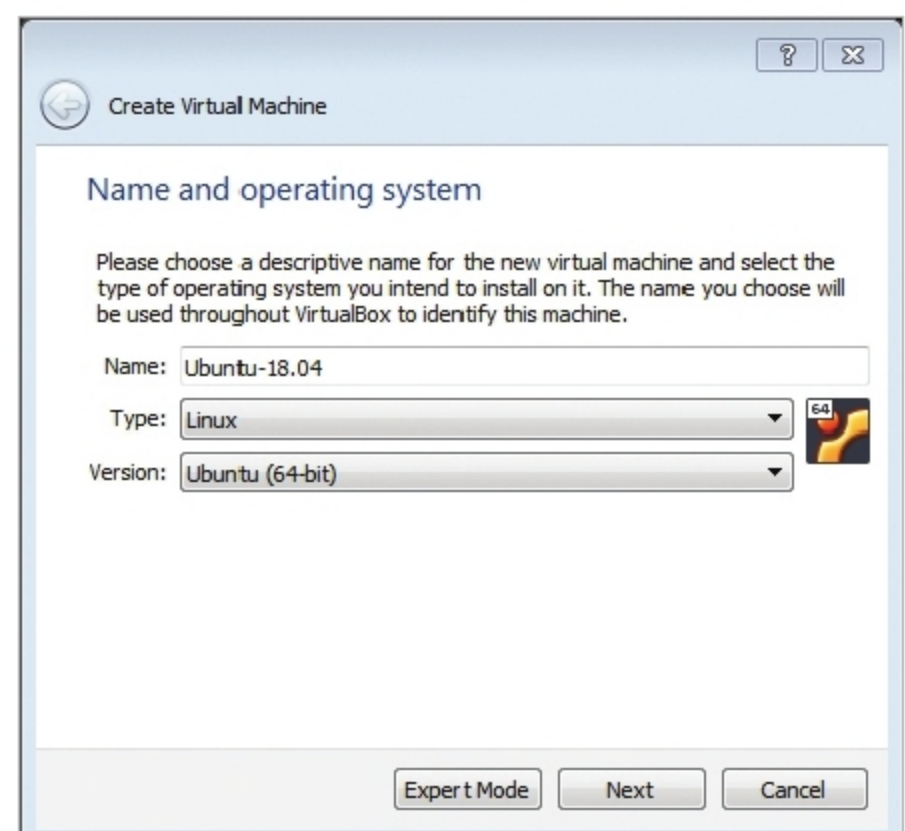


Figure 2: Creating a virtual machine